PREPARED FOR THE CONTRACTOR

V2 · SPRING 2026

The team that makes the yes sustainable — and the template the next reserve inherits.

A community development contract at $60k+/month is a real inflection point. It only stays a yes if the practitioner's days with the kids stay sacred, the on-the-ground execution doesn't depend on one tired person, and the band gets infrastructure that outlasts the engagement. Below: the operating structure, the financial model with a 35% reinvestment markup, and the path from one pilot to a repeatable template.

THE COST BASIS · LOADED MONTHLY · SCENARIO A FLOOR

Role	What it absorbs	Monthly	Adds at
Practitioner / Lead	Engagement owner; strategic + field work	**$14,000**	A
Operations Manager	Phone, depot, day-of fires; 807 ops + Deer Lake distribution	**$8,500**	A
IT/Tech	Server fleet, privacy phones, transparency stack, store IT	**$9,500**	A
Bookkeeper / Admin	Invoicing, contracts, CRA, agency back office	**$2,500**	A
Food Handler	Headwaters-owned, embedded at the Deer Lake store from Day 1: salt batches, 807-branded piecework, kitchen/shop tidy, food & supplies inventory	**$5,000**	A
CD Associate	Pilot #2 readiness; community-facing engagement	**$7,500**	B
Junior Analyst / Field	Data, household price lookups, fieldwork	**$6,500**	B
Senior Engineer #2 + Outreach + Trainer	Server resilience, pilot #2 sourcing, council training	**$26,500**	C
Life supports + overhead	Cleaner, tutor, handyman, tooling/SaaS, recurring tech ops (statutory buffer absorbed by Food Handler at the floor)	**$5,700**	A
Facilities — aggregation hub	Dad-warehouse · $2,200 rent + utilities, all-in (garage + house-next-door priced as expansion options; see /lease-tooling)	**$3,000**	A
Cost basis	A · floor → B · recommended → C · scale	**$48,200 / $69,700 / $99,100**	

BILL SCENARIOS — COST BASIS + REINVESTMENT MARKUP (35% TARGET)

Scenario	Cost basis	Reinvestment	Bill / month	Bridge needed
A · floor	$48,200	$11,800 (24%)	**$60,000**	~$96k
B · recommended	$69,700	$20,300 (29%)	**$90,000**	~$181k
C · scale	$99,100	$25,900 (26%)	**$125,000**	~$258k

Cost basis includes the Dad-warehouse aggregation hub ($3k/mo all-in; see /lease-tooling for the related-party documentation). Bridge = M2 trough on a net-60 cycle (two months of cost basis + day-one tech CAPEX of $0 / $42k / $60k). Recovered when the last two invoices clear. 35% reinvestment is the target; the actual % drifts as the cost basis grows.

WHAT THE 35% REINVESTMENT BUYS (RECOMMENDED ASK)

Destination	Year 1	What it ships
Tech CAPEX	~$60k	9 self-hosted servers, 6 privacy phones, 8 work computers, networking
Tooling subscriptions	~$24k	Transparency dashboard hosting, GIS, secure comms, project ops, payroll

Destination	Year 1	What it ships
Training & R&D	~$36k	Indigenous-services certifications, conferences, documented playbook hours
Pilot #2 reserve	~$160k	Held in a separate account; seeds the next reserve so they don't wait for grants

WHAT IT COSTS THE NEXT RESERVE · CROSS-RESERVE PRICING

DEER LAKE · RECURRING SOFTWARE CONTRACT

$420,000 /yr · $35,000/mo · locked

RESERVE #2 · Y1 ALL-IN STICKER (PLANNING ESTIMATE)

~$201,000 install + travel + Y1 retainer

~$148.5k install (12-week stint, ~30 on-site + ~24 remote days) + ~$22.5k travel pass-through* + $30k first-year retainer ≈ ~$201k Y1 all-in. Same headline as the Deer Lake deck's *First reserve, then the next* slide — kept here so the band council reads the symmetry to Deer Lake's $420k/yr the moment they print.

* Planning estimate (Deer Lake corridor: ~$1,000/return × 12 wks + $250/night × 30 + $100/day × 30). The receiving reserve replaces this with their own corridor's costs; travel is pass-through at cost, not in the practitioner's fee.

SALT COST-CENTRE · SALT-01 NET CONTRIBUTION TO THE AGENCY P&L

PLANNING BASELINE · PRE-FILING

$5,083 / mo (~$61k/yr)

WHOLESALE CM% · FLOOR 50%

63% · planning

STATUS

PRE-FILING

Planning baseline ~$61k/yr net (~$5.1k/mo) at wholesale CM 63%. Once the bookkeeper files a monthly close at `/salt-monthly-close`, the live figure replaces the baseline here.

THE ASK

A monthly retainer of **$90,000** against a 12-month engagement, reviewed at month 6, plus acknowledgement that **~$181,000 of bridge capital** is required on day one to cover team payroll plus tech CAPEX (cost basis includes the Dad-warehouse aggregation hub at $3k/mo all-in; see /lease-tooling) before the first net-60 invoice clears. 35% is the target reinvestment line — audited annually; the actual % drifts as the cost basis grows.

NET-POSITIVE ACCOUNTABILITY

The markup is upfront. The receipts are public: **procurement savings delivered**, time returned to band staff, transparency tools shipped & adopted, capacity built locally, **year-end value-delivered audit**. If the value delivered doesn't beat the markup, we credit forward.